

Awake, My Soul, Stretch Every Nerve

- 1 Awake, my soul, stretch ev'ry nerve,
and press with vigor on;
a heav'nly race demands thy zeal,
and an immortal crown,
and an immortal crown.
- 2 A cloud of witnesses around
hold thee in full survey:
forget the steps already trod,
and onward urge thy way,
and onward urge thy way.
- 3 'Tis God's all animating voice
that calls thee from on high;
'tis his own hand presents the prize
to thine aspiring eye,
to thine aspiring eye:
- 4 That prize with peerless glories bright,
which shall new luster boast,
when victors' wreaths and monarchs' gems
shall blend in common dust,
shall blend in common dust.
- 5 Blest Savior, introduced by thee,
have I my race begun;
and, crowned with vict'ry at thy feet
I'll lay my honors down,
I'll lay my honors down.

Words: Philip Doddridge, 1755

Music: Harmonia Sacra, 1812; arr. from George Frederick Handel, 1728

Tune: CHRISTMAS · 8.6.8.6.6 · Scripture: Hebrews 12:1

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